We can talk to each other. And we can go home to Brooklyn and Romeo. It doesn't matter what's been going on around me the rest of a day. I walk into the house and, as soon as I'm with the boys, nothing else matters but them. They're more thrilling to me—every single day—than anything else in my life. People must look at the lifestyle that comes with being Mr and Mrs Beckham and imagine it's all mad, all completely unreal. Some of it seems that way to us as well. But the foundations for me are the same as those for anybody else with a family. Inside Bubble Beckham, there's another bubble: it keeps the four of us safe—and sane—inside it. My real world, where I find what I need for the rest of the adventure, is with Victoria, Brooklyn and Romeo. There's nothing unusual about that, is there? I'm myself, both feet on the ground, like any other husband and father, when I'm at home with my wife and my sons. It's like Victoria said when we were talking about the move to Madrid:

'This is a huge thing, a huge change in our lives: a different country, a different way of life. But this is just a time to get our heads down and get on with it, concentrating on the things that really matter. You play your soccer—and you'd better play well—and I'll do my music. And for the rest of it, we'll be where we need to be: you, me and the boys. The family.'

They matter that much to me, Victoria, Brooklyn and Romeo, that I'll travel backwards and forwards from wherever just to spend an hour or two at home. Over the years, it was never a problem for me to drive from Manchester to London to stay overnight and leave early the next morning, as long as we weren't too close to a United game. I know some people would sweat over the mileage but I've never found being behind the wheel tiring. It's always been like that with Victoria: our first date, after all, was a 400-mile round trip for me but I'm pretty glad I didn't decide to stay in that night and watch television instead. I suppose when we were boyfriend and girlfriend, especially when Victoria was out of the country for long stretches, it did get a little extreme even for me. I remember one day, during the summer vacation towards the end of the Spice Girls' world tour, when I flew to Texas and back just to spend an hour in a VIP lounge with Victoria at Dallas airport. More than once, I flew out to where she was so that we could get back on the plane and fly home together. Now? With the children to think about, I might not do those things any more. But that doesn't mean that I wouldn't still want to.

I suppose if I'm not used to airplanes by now I never will be. The passport's picked up some interesting stamps: a photoshoot in Japan, a TV commercial in Spain, a sponsors' event in Vietnam, an awards ceremony in Los Angeles. It could be anything. It could be anywhere. I'm glad someone